

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

The Revolution of Microcomputers



Microsoft®

Learning Outcome:

Identify information about the history of software and its characteristics in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- Why do you think companies like Microsoft and Apple became popular?
- What's the importance of a microprocessor in a computer?

Can Do Statements:

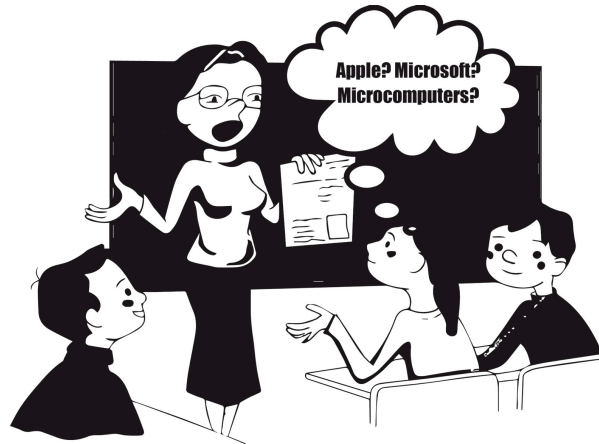
- I can discuss information about the microcomputer revolution.
- I can talk about facts about the origin of the Microsoft company.
- I can mention ideas about the origin of the Apple company.





Let's Explore!

Talking About the Birth of Microsoft and Apple



Instructions: Read the text below.

Luisa: Mark, what are you reading?

Mark: I'm reading about the birth of microcomputers.

Luisa: That sounds interesting. So, what does it say?

Mark: Well, it starts by explaining that there were not many people interested in buying the 4004 microprocessor at the beginning because people didn't know what to use microcomputers for. However, in 1974, with the 8080 microprocessors, people realized that these devices were good enough for running small computers. After this success, microcomputers began to evolve even faster and they became cheaper. For example, the Altair microprocessor was a big success and one of its strengths was its open architecture. This means that you could add extra attributes by developing plug-in cards.

Luisa: There wasn't any software at that time for programming computers, right?

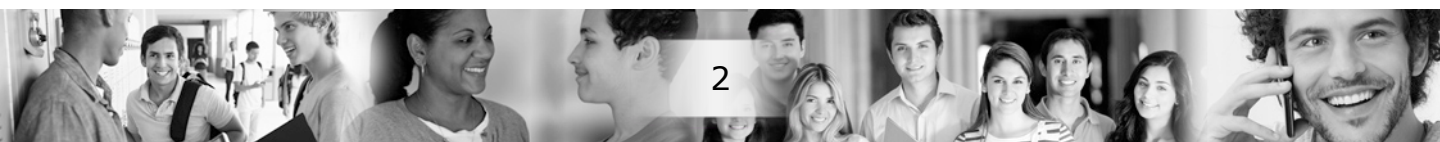
Mark: No. That's why Microsoft was invented. Both Paul Allen and Bill Gates liked to play with computers in high school and they decided to write Altair BASIC, an interpreter for computers. As the software they created was successful, they decided to found the Microsoft company.

Luisa: So, there weren't any competitors at that time for Microsoft, right?

Mark: That's right, but not for long. As Altair was getting more popular, more people became interested in the subject. This was when both Steve Wozniak and Steve Jobs decided to build a computer called Apple I, that was powered by the 6502 microprocessor. This first computer was very popular and they soon started their business. By 1977, they released the Apple II which was a big success because it was very easy to use.

Luisa: So, there weren't many competitors for Apple at that time.

Mark: They were one of the most important companies. But the low cost and the ease of programming microcomputers brought a lot of new people into the software industry.





Let's Practice!

Let's consider the following facts about the history of microcomputers.

Instructions: Write the words to correctly complete the sentences. Use words from the box below. Be careful with the distractors.

there wasn't some / there wasn't a / there were not many people /
was not an easy / was not a difficult / there were lots of people

1. Before 1972, _____ clear understanding of the functioning of a microprocessor.
2. Before the 1970s, _____ creating microcomputers. At that time, computers were big and expensive.
3. The first microcomputers needed to be assembled by the buyers. There _____ way to use them.



Let's Practice!

The Foundation of Microsoft

Instructions: Read the text. Underline the facts that are true according to the text.

Some Facts on the History of Microsoft

Both Bill Gates and Paul Allen were interested in the development of computers. They were friends since they were little, they even hacked their school's computer. It was not until 1975 that Allen and Gates became popular because they wrote a new version of a programming language called BASIC. The name of their new version was Altair BASIC. After that, Microsoft was born, it was officially founded in 1975.

1. Which of these facts are true according to the paragraph?
 - a. Both Bill Gates and Paul Allen weren't interested in the development of computers.
 - b. Both Bill Gates and Paul Allen weren't responsible for the hacking of their school's computer.
 - c. Both Bill Gates and Paul Allen were friends since they were little.
 - d. Both Gates and Allen created Altair BASIC.
 - e. Both Gates and Allen invented a programming language.
 - f. Microsoft wasn't founded in 1975.



Extension Activity

The Most Important Companies

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look for important dates in the history of both Microsoft and Apple.
- Make a timeline with the facts you found.
- Write specific facts and dates.
- Design a poster and include the information, add pictures and show the poster to the class.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

- I look for information about the history of Apple and Microsoft.
- I organize that information chronologically on a poster.
- I share my poster with my classmates.

☐	☐
☐	☐
☐	☐



Target Words

- **competitor** (noun): a person or group of people that compete against another one
e.g. So, there weren't any competitors at that time for Microsoft, right?
- **microprocessor** (noun): a device in a computer that controls what the computer does
e.g. There were not many people interested in buying the 4004 microprocessor at the beginning because people didn't know what to use microcomputers for.
- **realize** (verb): to gradually notice or to understand something gradually
e.g. With the 8080 microprocessor, people realized that these devices were good enough for running small computers.
- **plug-in cards** (noun): cards with new information that can be plugged in to the computer
e.g. This means that you could add extra attributes by developing plug-in cards.
- **success** (noun): to achieve or fulfill a positive result of something
e.g. After this success, microcomputers began to evolve even faster and they became cheaper.
- **found** (verb): to establish something such as a company or business
e.g. As the software they created was successful, they decided to found the Microsoft company.



Learning Points

There Be in Simple Past Negative Statements

We use **there was** or **there were** to talk about the existence of something in the past.

When we want to say that something did not exist or that didn't take place in the past, we can use **there was** or **there were** in its **negative form**:

There + verb 'to be' in simple past and negative form (**was not / were not**)
+ complement.

Example:

There were not many microcomputers at that time.

Remember that we use **there was** when we talk about singular objects. On the other hand, we use **there were** when we talk about plural objects.

Let's take a look at the following examples:

There were not many microprocessors in 1960.

There was not any microprocessor in 1960.

We can also use the contracted form of the **verb 'to be'** and the particle **not**:

There were not = **there weren't**

There was not = **there wasn't**

Examples

- *There wasn't any software at that time for programming computers.*
- *So, there weren't any competitors at that time for Microsoft, right?*
- *There weren't many competitors for Apple.*





Learning Points

Both to Refer to Two Nouns in a Pair

We use **both** to talk about two things that go together.

When we want to show the relationship between two things, we can use **both**.

Let's consider the following example:

Both Microsoft and Apple made important innovations in the software industry.

We place **both** before the nouns that we are referring to.

For example:

Both the **price** and **size** of computers were reduced for making computers more affordable.

Both Carlie and Joshua understand the importance of microprocessors in computers.

Examples

- *Both Paul Allen and Bill Gates liked to play with computers in high school.*
- *This was when both Steve Wozniak and Steve Jobs decided to build a computer called Apple I that was powered by the 6502 microprocessor.*